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About

An English-language reference for public transport across Taiwan — Taipei and New Taipei, Taoyuan, Taichung, Kaohsiung and the systems beyond them — written because the material exists in Mandarin and nowhere else in a form you can look something up in.

What this is

Taiwan's transport network is unusually well documented — in Mandarin. Between 批踢踢 (PTT), Mobile01 and the Chinese Wikipedia there is detailed, argued-over coverage of rolling stock, depot allocations, signalling contracts and construction history, for systems from Taipei Metro to Kaohsiung Rapid Transit to the branch lines of Taiwan Railway. Some of it is better than anything published officially.

In English there is an encyclopedia article per line and a great deal of visitor-facing advice about which exit to use. What is missing is the layer in between: structured reference material you can look a fact up in, with the source attached, and covering the country rather than one city. That gap is what this site is for.

It is independent and non-commercial. It is not affiliated with any transit operator — Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation, New Taipei Metro, Taoyuan Metro, Taichung Metro, Kaohsiung Rapid Transit, Taiwan Railway, Taiwan High Speed Rail, any city or county government, or any bus, ferry or bike-share operator — and it carries no advertising.

How it sources material

Official data where it exists

For the 198 stations the platform carries, names, codes, running order, coordinates, interchanges, route lengths and end-to-end times come from TDX [<https://tdx.transportdata.tw/>], the Ministry of Transportation and Communications' open data platform. So do 10 of the 11 line colours, from the publishing operator's own line record. The exception is the Sanying Line, which opened in June 2026 and has no record on the platform at all; its colour was read instead from the operator's own line mark, and the line colours page [</data/line-colours/>] says exactly which file and what it was checked against. TDX has no Sanying station dataset either, so LB01–LB12 are maintained in a separate hand-researched registry from the operator's station table and twelve information sheets. Every displayed Sanying fact links to that primary evidence, and coordinates remain TBC. The generated TDX registry itself is not hand-edited.

That decision has already paid for itself twice. Every English-language line colour we could find was wrong, including two cases where a confident correction citing an official map moved *away* from the official value — the working is on the colours page [\[/data/line-colours/\]](/data/line-colours/). And the route length this site published was 1.4 km too long, because it measured geometry that runs past both termini into depot leads, while the operator's own figure sat unread in a field nobody had looked in.

Mandarin sources, synthesised rather than translated

Where official data stops — fleet histories, depot facilities, the Matra contract dispute, why a line was built the way it was — the material is in Mandarin. The policy is to read it, cross-check it, and write it in English from scratch, citing the original in its own language rather than an English mirror of it. Translating a forum thread wholesale would be both a copyright problem and a way of importing its errors without noticing them.

Where sources disagree, the intention is to record every value rather than pick the most plausible one and present it as settled.

TBC rather than a guess

A figure marked *TBC* means nobody here has traced it to a source worth citing. It does not mean the number is unknown to the world. It would be easy to fill those gaps with figures that are probably right, and the site would look more finished; it would also stop being usable as a reference, because you could no longer tell which numbers had been checked.

The same applies structurally. A section that has not been researched yet says so on its own index page rather than being hidden or padded out. Where a figure has been settled since — the two underground Wenhui Line stations were marked “not established” for four builds and are now named, from the builder's own record and an encyclopedia agreeing from different directions — the page says how it was settled rather than quietly filling the gap.

Citations, and a count of what has none

Every page carries a source list, and a figure that rests on one says so with a numbered mark you can follow. Each entry records the title in English and in the original language, the publisher, the date the URL was read, and whether the source is **primary** — the operator, the builder, a government department, a court — or **secondary**. That last field is required and has no default: this site has already found a case where a citation to an official route map was further from the published colour than the value it replaced, so who says a thing has to travel with the thing.

Everything cited anywhere is collected in the bibliography [\[/data/sources/\]](/data/sources/), with the primary-to-secondary ratio stated at the top. It is currently about a third primary, which is not good enough and is published anyway.

The build also counts statements that carry *no* source at all, separately from those marked TBC, and refuses to let that number grow. A labelled gap and an unlabelled assertion are different failures, and only one of them is honest.

What is not used

No operator's route map, photography or signage artwork. Those are copyrighted. The maps on this site are drawn from published coordinate geometry, and the line colours are the published hex values — a colour specification is a fact, an operator's specific map is a design.

Data provenance [\[/data/provenance/\]](/data/provenance/) sets out field by field what is official, what is researched here, what is derived, and what is still open.

Where it has got to

Coverage grew outward from Taipei Metro's Wenzhou Line, this site's first deep case study, and now spans metro and light rail systems in Taipei, New Taipei, Taoyuan, Taichung and Kaohsiung; the national bus network across several cities; Taiwan Railway and High Speed Rail groundwork; ferries to the outlying islands; and YouBike. Depth is uneven by design — a system gets a page per station and per line once it has been researched to that standard, and a section not yet at that depth says so rather than padding itself out. 0 of the 720 written pages still carry a stub flag, meaning some figures on them still need tracing to a primary source.

All 210 rail stations the platform carries are registered, so any station code on the site validates and any of them can be looked up on the station records page [\[/data/stations/\]](/data/stations/), with position, district, coordinates, interchanges and run times where the source publishes them. Where TDX does not publish structure, street exits or engineering numbers, some lines carry a hand-built overlay sourced from the operator directly instead — the station page for any given line says which kind of record it is.

Corrections

Corrections are welcome, and specific ones are most useful: the page, the figure, and what it should be, with a source. A source in Mandarin is as good as one in English, and often better.

The most valuable corrections are the ones that catch something stated confidently and wrongly, rather than something already marked TBC — a gap that is labelled is doing its job, but a wrong figure presented as checked undermines everything next to it.

Reporting a correction. Open an issue on the repository this site is built from, quoting the page URL and the figure in question. If you would rather not use an issue tracker, the same information sent any other way is just as welcome — what matters is the source, not the channel.

How it is built

Content is Markdown; the site is generated as static HTML and served as files, with no server and no runtime API calls. Station code badges, Chinese language tagging, strip maps and geographic maps are all produced at build time from the data, which is why a station code that is not real fails the build rather than rendering as though it were.

Station and line data retrieved from MOTC TDX on 2026-08-24. Government open data, used under the Open Government Data Licence.

An independent, non-commercial reference site. Not affiliated with any transit operator or government body in Taiwan. Line colours are the official values published by each operator through Taiwan MOTC's open data platform. **About this site.**

Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.